READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

The Animal Connection

Professor of anthropology Pat Shipman looks at the ways in which our relationships with animals have shaped our own human evolution.

Travel anywhere and you see something so common it may not even catch your attention. Wherever there are people, animals are being walked, herded and fed. Many, such as dogs, cats and sheep, are domesticated, but you will also find people living alongside wild creatures like monkeys and wolves. Close contact with animals is not confined to one particular culture, region or ethnic group but is a universal human trait.

On the face of it this makes little sense. No other mammal adopts individuals from another species, with good reason. Since the ultimate prize in evolution is perpetuating your genes, providing food for another species is counterproductive to success. Even if pets offer friendship, that cannot explain why our bond with other species arose in the first place. Who would bring a ferocious wolf into their home in the hope that thousands of years later it would become a loving pet?

As an anthropologist I have tried to understand this puzzle by looking to the past for the origins of our link with animals. What I found was a long and unbroken evolutionary trail of evidence I call the 'animal connection'. This trail links to three important developments in human evolution: tool making, language and domestication. If I am correct, and I believe that further research will conclusively show that I am, the animal connection is a hugely significant force instrumental in our global success.

The trail begins at least 2.6 million years ago. That is when the first tools appear in the archaeological record. This development required the intellectual breakthrough of realizing that the properties of an object can be altered. Man learnt how to turn stone into small, sharp items that could cut up animal carcasses, providing them with an evolutionary shortcut to becoming predators.

There were many consequences of the new hunting lifestyle. On the plus side, eating more meat and fat was a requirement for the increase in relative brain size. And since meat tends to come in bigger packages than leaves and roots, meat eaters could spend less time finding food and more on activities like learning and social interaction. On the minus side, preying on animals put our ancestors into direct competition with the other predators that shared their ecosystem, animals such as lions and hyenas. To get the upper hand, they needed more than just tools, and that is where the animal connection comes in. What made it possible for our ancestors to compete successfully with true carnivores was the ability to pay very close attention to the habits of both potential prey and competitors. Knowledge

was power, so we acquired a deep understanding of the minds of other animals. Another significant consequence of becoming more predatory was the need to live at lower densities, as successful predators soon exhaust food supplies. The record of the geographic distribution of our ancestors provides further support for my idea that the animal connection has shaped our evolution. Early man lived in Africa and nowhere else, but then underwent a dramatic expansion in territory, forced by the search for new hunting grounds.

Throughout the period of these enormous changes in the lifestyle of our ancestors, gathering, sharing and recording knowledge became increasingly advantageous, and examples of prehistoric art that appear in Europe, Asia, Africa and Australia allow us to eavesdrop on their conversations. Through the art, we realize the main topic was animals: their colours, shapes, postures and habits. This focus is even more striking considering that scenes of human life are rarely depicted. Pictures of people, social interaction and ceremonies are rare.

This leads me on to the development of language. Nobody doubts this proved a major adaptive advantage to our ancestors in developing complex behaviours. How it arose, however, remains a mystery. I believe I am the first to propose a continuity between the strong human-animal link that appeared 2.6 million years ago and the origin of language. The complexity and importance of animal-related information, indicated in the predominance of animal images, spurred early humans to move beyond what other species could achieve. Vervet monkeys, for example, have different cries for eagles and snakes, but they cannot discuss what threats might appear tomorrow. The property of full language is that it is comprised of vocabulary and grammatical rules that can be combined in an infinite number of ways to convey fine shades of meaning.

As our ancestors became more involved with animals, the third product of the animal connection appeared: domestication, which has long been linked with the keeping of animals like sheep. Domestic animals are usually considered as ‘walking larders’, or easy food sources, reflecting the idea that the basis of this change was a drive for greater food security. Looking at the origins of domestication for clues to its underlying reasons, I found fundamental flaws in this idea. Instead, my analysis suggests domestication emerged as a natural progression of our close association with, and understanding of, other species. If domestication was about knowing where your next meal was coming from, the first domesticate ought to have been a food source, yet analysis of fossils shows that the domestication of dogs pre-dated that of any other species, even plants, from wolves. Furthermore, if the objective was to have meat to eat, you wouldn’t select an animal that eats two kilograms of meat a day. It was familiarity with this species that led to eventual domestication.

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet, write

YES	*if the statement agrees with the views of the writer*
NO	*if the statement contradicts the views of the writer*
NOT GIVEN	*if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

27 Travellers are more likely to notice wild animals than domesticated ones.

28 All cultures demonstrate a need to have close contact with animals.

29 Animals benefit from allowing other animal species to share food resources.

30 It is unlikely that people initially domesticated wolves for future companionship.

31 There are periods of human evolution for which we have little information about man's relationship with animals.

Questions 32–36

Complete the summary using the list of words, ***A–J****, below.*

Write the correct letter, ***A–J****, in boxes 32–36 on your answer sheet.*

Hunting and the animal connection

Around 2.6 million years ago, humans became predators after they realized the possibility of object **32** _____. Once humans were hunters, they benefited from better **33** _____ and extra time which could be spent on non-physical activities. However, the more humans came to depend on meat as a food source, the more **34** _____ there was between them and other predators. Humans needed to find an advantage over animals such as lions and hyenas. It wasn't a spear or knife that gave them this advantage, but the **35** _____ skills that humans began to develop. Then, because humans were such successful predators, they required more **36** _____ and this led to groups of people moving away from Africa.

A	nutrition	**B**	competition	**C**	leadership	**D**	adaptation
E	territory	**F**	trade	**G**	connection	**H**	observation
I	behavior	**J**	worship				

Questions 37–40

Choose the correct letter, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C****, or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.

37 What is the writer's main argument in the sixth paragraph?

A Prehistoric art allows us to date human migration patterns.
B Early man valued the communication of knowledge about animal behaviour and appearance.
C There is evidence of big lifestyle differences between early humans in different regions.
D There was little spoken interaction between different groups of people.

38 What is the writer doing in the seventh paragraph?

A rejecting an established theory about human evolution.
B emphasizing the value of art in language development.
C expressing doubt about the initial purpose of communication.
D making a claim about the way that language developed.

39 The writer refers to vervet monkeys in order to:

A indicate which animal species have a kind of basic language.
B show how danger is a significant motivation for human communication.
C highlight the sophistication of human communication.
D suggest a possible influence on the way early humans interacted.

40 The writer says that the 'walking larder' idea

A fails to explain the purpose of domestication.
B is true only for domesticated animals.
C supports the idea the writer proposes.
D is based on research the writer has carried out.

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Questions 27–31（YES / NO / NOT GIVEN）

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句（第 X 段）	定位句翻译	详细解释（同义改写 / 排除）
27	**NOT GIVEN**	旅行者更可能注意到**野生动物**，而不是驯养动物。	第1段：*“you see something so common it may not even catch your attention.”*	你会看到一些非常常见的事物，甚至可能不会引起注意。	文章只说“人与动物共处很常见，常见到可能不注意”，并列举既有**驯养动物**也有**野生动物**，但**没有比较**“更容易注意到哪一种”。题干是“wild vs domesticated 的注意力对比”，原文**没有结论** → **NG**。
28	**YES**	所有文化都表现出需要与动物保持密切接触。	第1段：*“Close contact with animals … is a universal human trait.”*	与动物的密切接触……是一种普遍的人类特征。	“universal human trait” ≈ “所有文化/地区/族群都存在（普遍性）”。题干的“All cultures”与原文“not confined to one culture… universal”同义 → **YES**。
29	**NO**	动物允许其他物种共享食物资源会从中受益。	第2段：*“providing food for another species is counterproductive to success.”*	给另一个物种提供食物会**不利于**（进化）成功。	题干说“benefit（受益）”，原文说“counterproductive（适得其反）”。方向完全相反 → **NO**。
30	**YES**	人类最初驯化狼**不太可能**是为了未来的陪伴。	第2段：*“Who would bring a ferocious wolf … in the hope that … it would become a loving pet?”*	谁会把凶猛的狼带回家，只为了希望几千年后它变成可爱的宠物?	这是反问=作者态度：**几乎不可能有人当初为了“未来陪伴”去做这件事**。题干的“unlikely”与反问语气一致 → **YES**。
31	**NO**	人类进化中有些时期，我们对人与动物关系的信息很少。	第3段：*“a long and unbroken … trail of evidence”*	一条漫长且**不断裂**的证据链。	题干说“信息很少/空白期”，原文强调“long and **unbroken** trail of evidence（证据不断裂）”。含义冲突 → **NO**。

Questions 32–36（Summary 填空：A–J）

题号	答案	题干翻译（含空）	精确定位句（第 X 段）	定位句翻译	详细解释（为什么是它 / 其它词为何不行）
32	**D adaptation**	人类成为捕食者源于意识到物体 **32**_____ 的可能性。	第4段：*“the properties of an object can be altered.”*	物体的属性可以被改变。	“altered/changed” ≈ **adaptation（改变以适应/改造）**。其他词如 behavior/connection/leadership 不表达“把物体改造成工具”的关键点。
33	**A nutrition**	成为猎人后，人类受益于更好的 **33**_____，并获得更多时间做非体力活动。	第5段：*“eating more meat and fat…”*；*“spend less time finding food…”*	吃更多肉和脂肪……找食物花更少时间……	肉和脂肪带来更高能量与营养结构 → **nutrition（营养）**最贴合。“trade/leadership/worship”等与饮食收益无关。
34	**B competition**	越依赖肉食，人类与其他捕食者之间的 **34**_____ 越强。	第5段：*“direct competition with the other predators…”*	与其他捕食者形成直接竞争。	原文原词“competition”，直选 **B**。
35	**H observation**	优势不是武器，而是人类开始发展的 **35**_____ 技能。	第5段：*“pay very close attention to the habits…”*	非常仔细地关注（猎物与竞争者的）习性。	“pay very close attention” ≈ **observation（观察）**。不是 leadership（领导力），也不是 connection（联系），核心是“观察习性/读懂动物”。
36	**E territory**	因捕食成功，需要更多 **36**_____，导致人群离开非洲。	第5段：*“a dramatic expansion in territory… search for new hunting grounds.”*	领地显著扩张……寻找新的狩猎地。	原文直接说“expansion in **territory** / new hunting grounds”，因资源消耗要扩大活动范围 → **E**。

Questions 37–40（单选 A/B/C/D）

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句（第 X 段）	定位句翻译	详细解释（选项排除）
37	**B**	第6段作者的主要论点是什么?	第6段：*“gathering, sharing and recording knowledge…”*；*“main topic was animals: their colours… habits.”*	收集、分享、记录知识越来越有利……艺术作品显示主要主题是动物：颜色、形态、姿态、习性。	**B**“早期人类重视交流关于动物行为与外观的知识”=第6段中心：**知识交流 + 内容以动物为主**。A（用艺术给迁徙定年）文中没说“date patterns”；C（不同地区生活方式差异巨大）不是段落主旨；D（群体间口头交流很少）与“sharing knowledge”相反。
38	**D**	第7段作者在做什么?	第7段：*“I… propose a continuity… human-animal link… origin of language.”*	我提出：人类—动物联系与语言起源之间存在连续性。	作者在**提出语言如何产生/发展的主张**（把语言起源与“动物相关信息的复杂性”联系起来）→ **D**。A“否定既有理论”不对；B“强调艺术价值”是第6段；C“怀疑沟通初衷”不是重点。
39	**C**	作者提到长尾猴（vervet monkeys）是为了：	第7段：*“have different cries… but they cannot discuss what threats might appear tomorrow.”*	它们有不同叫声，但无法讨论“明天可能出现什么威胁”。	用猴子的“有限信号系统”来反衬人类语言的**高级性/复杂性**（能表达未来、抽象、组合无限）→ **C**。A“指出哪些动物有基本语言”不是目的；B“危险是沟通动机”只是例子表层；D“影响人类互动方式”文中没讲。
40	**A**	作者认为“walking larder（会走的粮仓）”观点：	第8段：*“I found fundamental flaws in this idea.”*；*“Instead… domestication emerged…”*	我发现这个观点有根本缺陷……相反，驯化源于亲近与理解。	作者明确说“walking larder”解释有缺陷，**不能解释驯化的根本原因**（他认为是“熟悉/亲近/理解”推动）→ **A**。B“只适用于驯化动物”不是作者说法；C“支持作者观点”相反；D“基于作者研究”虽提到分析，但题干问的是该观点在作者看来“起什么作用/问题是什么”，核心是“解释失败”。